encountered during previous battles meant that they were unable to continue with their planned advance. From this point on, Syrian forces mounted only a few attacks on Jewish settlements in the area but were unable to occupy any more territory or to continue their advance.

By mid-June, the IDF had been able to block each of the four invading Arab armies. The invaders had been able to occupy some territory, including 14 Jewish settlements, though only one of these, Mishmar HaYarden, was within the area proposed as being under Israeli control in the partition agreement recommended by the UN. In contrast, Israeli forces remained in control of large parts of Palestine, including the Arab towns and cities of New Jerusalem, Haifa, Jaffa, Baysan, Acre, Safed, Tiberias, Samakh, and Yibna.

The most unpleasant surprise for the Arab forces had been the scale and ferocity of the resistance they faced. Many Arab military commanders had expected a swift victory and little resistance. When they were blocked and suffered heavy casualties in virtually every attempt to occupy territory, morale among their troops dropped abruptly. By fighting the four invading forces to a standstill, the IDF had also bought itself vital time to allow arms shipments to arrive and for new recruits to join.

When the war started, the IDF had in the region of 30,000 troops, though many of these could not be provided with weapons. They also had no artillery and no combat aircraft. One month later, the IDF had around 60,000 troops in the field, and supplies of weapons and ammunition were improving all the time. The first artillery was being distributed to IDF forces, and most surprising of all, the IDF had been able to field combat aircraft, something that had taken its Arab opponents completely by surprise. The S-199 aircraft provided from Czechoslovakia were few in number and not particularly effective, but none of the Arab armies had expected to find themselves under air attack at all, and the appearance of IDF combat aircraft came as a shock that further impacted morale in the Arab armies.

Yet despite its success in defense, the IDF had suffered serious casualties, including experienced officers (the IDF's first general, Mickey Marcus, was killed during the attempts to take Latrun fortress). Both sides were becoming exhausted, and when the UN proposed a 28-day ceasefire, this was happily accepted.